

VertiGO!!!



Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 733 OCTOBER 2010, PO BOX 1628 WELLINGTON



Scene from the Reel Rock film tour – screening in Wellington on Monday 22 November

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Next section night: 1 November 2010

The Numbers Game by Don French

Take a slightly bored accountant, a mad professor, then add the Centennial year of the Alpine Club and you have the makings of The Numbers Game.

The number game is a personal odyssey where Don French attempts to climb all the peaks on the "100 Peaks Challenge" list.

This is an epic bigger than "The Lord of the Rings". Well it's making is definitely longer. And almost two decades later the challenge is still uncompleted. The journey takes us from East Cape to deepest darkest Fiordland, all because of a throw-away comment in a hut one night which one has to live up to.





NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB



PRESENT
**THE FIFTH ANNUAL
REEL
ROCK
Film
TOUR
FALL 2010**

BIG UP PRODUCTIONS AND SENDER FILMS PRESENT CLIMBING ACTION
FROM AROUND THE GLOBE: DANIEL WOODS + PAUL ROBINSON PUSH
BOULDERING LIMITS, PETER CROFT + LISA RANDS IGNITE THE SIERRAS,
UELI STECK SPEED SOLOS THE ALPS, DEAN POTTER CONTINUES HIS
MADNESS, A TASMANIAN MEGA ADVENTURE AND MORE!
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Climbing
MAGAZINE
URBANCLIMBER



STERLING ROPE

7pm, Monday 22 November 2010
Lecture Theatre 1, Government Buildings,
Victoria University Law Faculty, Stout St, Wellington
Tickets available from HangDog - limited door sales

View the trailer at www.reelrocktour.com

Wellington Section NZ Alpine Club

Minutes of AGM

Date: Monday 6 September 2010
Venue: Turnbull House, Wellington
Chair: James Wright
Commenced: 8:20pm following normal section night admin

1. Apologies / Proxies

No apologies or proxies were received.

2. Minutes of previous AGM and matters arising

The minutes of the 2009 AGM have been on the section website since the last AGM and copies were made available at the meeting. There were no matters arising.

Blair Hiscoke moved that the 2009 AGM minutes be accepted. Seconded by Steve Minchin. Motion carried unanimously.

3. Annual Report

James Wright spoke to the Chairperson's report and highlighted the following key points:

- Club is undertaking a review around the incident where Paul McLauchlan lost his life. No conclusions have been reached yet.
- The section has again operated for another year without a chairperson.
- Section membership healthy at around 410.
- Instruction courses again popular
- The section's trips programme operating well.
- The section committed to lend \$20k to National for the Unwin Hut project. The section ran a consultation process and there was unanimous support for this.
- This loan means the section will need to manage its finances carefully.
- Distaghil Sar Fund – congratulations to Scott Taylor and Robin Maxwell who both received DSF awards.
- Richard Davies has been elected to the position of national FMC President
- Congratulations to John Nankervis and Nigel Roberts for the Queen's Honours.

Scott Taylor moved that the Annual Report be accepted. Seconded by Nicky McIndoe. Motion carried unanimously.

4. Treasurer's report

Richard Davies presented the Treasurer's report. Richard noted the following points:

- AIC revenue and expenses span two financial years so this is something to look at
- Banff, NZ Mountain film festivals were successful again.
- Steve Venables speaking was again a success. Thanks to Steve Minchen for organising these events.
- Noted the decision to make a loan to Unwin Hut project.

James Wright moved that the Treasurer's report be accepted. Peter Shanahan seconded. Motion carried unanimously.

5. Election of Section Officers

The following members were nominated: (Nominated by / seconded by)

Chairperson:	James Wright	(Catherine Moger / John Nankervis)
Vice-chair:	Scot Taylor	(James Wright / Kevin Patterson)
Secretary:	Catherine Moger	(Steve Minchin / Hinrich Schaefer)
Treasurer:	Matt Knarston	(Richard Davies / James Wright)

No further nominations for these positions were received. All members present in favour. Above members elected to these positions

6. Election of Section Rep to the National Club Committee

Noted that under national club rules, the section is entitled to one section representative. Richard Davies nominated James Wright as Wellington section rep. Seconded by Blair Hiscoke. No further nominations received. All members present in favour. James elected as section rep.

7. Section Patron

James Wright nominated John Nankervis for Wellington Section Patron.
Kevin Paterson seconded. All members present in favour. John Nankervis elected Patron.

8. Election of General committee members

Nominations for general committee were received for the following members:

- Hinrich Schaefer (Scott Taylor / Catherine Moger)
- Steve Minchen (Hinrich Schaefer / Catherine Moger)
- Rebecca Thomson (Steve Minchin / Scott Taylor)
- Vincent Zintzen (Hinrich Schaefer / Rebecca Thomson)
- Lorraine Johns (Catherine Moger / Richard Davies)
- Richard Davies (James Wright / Kevin Patterson)

No further nominations for these positions were received. All members present in favour. Above members elected to the committee.

Richard Davies put a motion to thank all outgoing committee members. Blair Hiscoke seconded.

9. Appointment of auditor

As the section does not have a continuing auditor James moved that “the committee be empowered to appoint an auditor as soon as possible” Nicky McIndoe seconded this motion. Motion carried.

10. General Business

- Noted that a new trips officer will be decided by the committee.
- Peter Cammell is leading the review of the AIC incident and this will what this will mean for AIC going forward.
- Scott Taylor took the opportunity to thank Don French for all his hard work as instruction coordinator.

There being no further business, the AGM closed at 8:48pm



TRIP REPORTS

Please send your trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.

Waikato A La Carte

In a bid to put a long, wet Wellington Winter behind them a group of six section members decided to head away for some rock climbing over Labour Weekend. Clark Alston, ShiChang Hou, Marcus Manning, Steve Minchin, Catherine Moger and James Wright headed North with a great forecast and a bag full of topo guides. Too much time in the gym had been like a diet consisting solely of protein powder, good for building the muscles but not very fulfilling. We needed something more to get our teeth into.

After overnighting in Turangi (a culinary desert) we headed to Mangaokewa on Saturday for our entrées. In the style of a rustic bistro we were offered some short lived but tasty fare. There was just us and a couple of other climbers, some parrots and the sound of the lesser spotted trail bike for company. We got our juices flowing with some crag classics such as Dogamatrix 17, Fond Memories of Rattlesnake Mountain 20 (pre GST rise according to James), Inflatable Gladiators 17, Trojan Kat 20 and Punk Rockers 19. The sun shone, it was a good day.



ShiChang tests himself against Inflatable Gladiators



Marcus gets stuck into the local Moonshine

Then it was off to Wharepapa to stay at Bryce's, where we were surprised by a special guest appearance from Yibai He, who had driven up from Wellington for a climb before he went to work on Monday!

For Sunday's main course we headed to Sheridan with the local maitre d's (Bryce) recommendations ringing in our ears. This was like a full-on, help yourself until you're full buffet. The climbs are long and interesting and most are more than your typical ignimbrite line of pockets up a wall, as they follow stonking lines. It's fair to say we gorged ourselves on many of the "signature dishes" of the region including Hebe 17, Carpe Diem 17, Galapagos 20, Ball and Chain 20, Canard 18, Cry wolf 23 and School Bus Route 19. Memorable moment of the day would have to be Steve's inadvertent ascent of Hannah Louise 18. He swears he ordered a number 15 off the menu! The sun shone, it was a great day.



Catherine glides up Hebe



Clark storms his way up the Monsterpiece Theatre headwall

Following more overnight R&R at Bryce's we completed our three courses at Froggatt. By this time our appetites were declining rapidly, although we all stepped up to sample some awesome desserts! I think Steve found God at the top of Terror Incognito 18, Marcus went for it on the finger shredding Vroom, Vroom Mentality 25 and James and I left our bodies somewhere up Animal Biscuit Valley! Other classic puds sampled included Sunstrike 21, Bonne Anne 16, Monsterpiece Theatre 20, Power Pack 18 and Total Energy 19. The sun shone, we were beginning to wish for the occasional cloud.

Our bellies were full. Time for a quick coffee and then the long drive home. Thanks for a great trip everyone!

Clark



UPCOMING CLUB TRIPS



Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. As we organise the Summer Trip Schedule we seek your input and engagement:

- What trips do you want to see on the schedule?
- Which trips are you willing to organise/lead?

We are looking for outings in our traditional activities, i.e. mountaineering and rock climbing, but we also recognise that our club consists of people with a large spectrum of outdoors activities. So if you are interested in organising a trip for tramping, mountain biking, trail running or similar activities we welcome your initiative. Note that trip members are required to be adequately trained and self-sufficient, so if you offer a trip it means, in most cases, organising the logistics rather than guiding folks through the terrain. So don't be shy!

In order to present a variety of attractive outings we rely on the community of members to become involved and we invite you to step forward with your suggestions and/or by volunteering as a trip organiser. Please send all input to Hinrich Schaefer (h.schaefer@niwa.co.nz). We look forward to a fun, challenging, and enticing trip schedule for the upcoming summer.



Tasman Saddle

Date: 19 – 28 November 2010

Trip coordinator: Rob Hawes

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Set aside space in your leave calendar for this one! This will be a week long trip into the Mt Cook NP glacier zone. Multiple peaks abound within easy distance of Tasman Saddle Hut including Mt Green, Elie de Beaumont, and the infamous Hochstetter Dome. On Friday night we'll fly down to Christchurch and drive to Mt Cook village, staying in Unwin Hut. On Saturday we will fly in to Tasman Saddle by ski plane and spend the following 8 days climbing. Or whatever. Sunday lunchtime we fly back out, and then drive back to Christchurch to catch our plane home. Contact Rob Hawes, ph 0274 470461 or 528 3692 (h) or RobertH@tfg.co.nz



Mt Taranaki / Egmont

Date: 26 – 28 November 2010

Trip coordinator: Steve Minchin

Level: trad climbing grade 18+

Do you enjoy climbing a stone's throw from the road end? Do you like clipping bolts? Do you like to belay whilst sitting under a tree, listening to the gentle burbling of a forest stream, and contemplating the fantails frolicking? If you answered "yes" to any of these questions, this trip might not be for you... If, however, you want to lug your kit halfway up a mountain, plug your own pro, and enjoy a bracing mountain wind then Mt Taranaki will float your boat. This is a great opportunity to get off the beaten track and climb some of the North Island's least frequented trad routes on some top quality rock. We'll be heading up on Thursday night to make the drive worthwhile and will be staying at the Taranaki Alpine Club's lodge on the mountain (one hour walk in, \$20 / night). The crag is all natural pro, and reports are that the pick of the routes are graded 18+. Dust off your nuts and come join the fun. Contact Steve at stevem@solutionz.co.nz for further info or to sign up.



Broken River, Arthur's Pass

Date: 2 – 9 January 2011

This year's Climbing Camp will be in the Broken River Ski Area from Sunday 2nd January to Sunday 9th January 2011. It will be hosted by the Caterbury/Westland Section and is a fantastic opportunity for climbers and their families to gather in the mountains for climbing, tramping and generally have fun. There is some fantastic climbing in the area: Rolleston, Murchison for Alpine climbers, Castle Hill and Quantun field for rock climbers. Plus there are lots of tramping opportunities too. See the NZAC website for details (<http://alpineclub.org.nz/default/377>). Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email him at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz for carpooling arrangements.



NOTICES



Gear theft

Club member Richard Knott had his car stolen from the Whakapapa Skifield carpark in October – and his car had \$11,000 of gear in the car. If you see some of this gear being sold and have any suspicions please contact Richard on 027 348 6657.

DMM 4cu Cams sizes: 1.5, 1.75, 2, 2, 3 and 4.

Black diamond Cams sizes: 1 and 2.

14 Trango wire gate biners and 4 bent gates.

Set of DMM wall nuts sizes: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, and 11.

Set of Metolius Alpine Curve Hexs sizes: 6, 7, 8, 9 and 10.

6 Austri alpine quick-draws.

2 Kong 'HMS' biners (twist lock, 2 Kong 'D' biners (screw gate), and 8 Trango 'D' biners (screw gate).

Petzl Tibloc.

Grivel Matrix Lite ice axe (Adze) and a Grivel Matrix Lite ice axe (hammer).

Pair of Grivel G14 Crampons.

Edelweiss climbing helmet.

Pair of La Sportiva Nepal Evo boots.

DMM Nut Buster.

Pair of Scarpa Vision Rock climbing shoes

Rock empire chalk bag.

Pair of Salewa Mountain Trainers.

North Face TKA 100 fleece.

DMM Renegade Harness.

DMM Belay Master biner and a DMM V-Twin Belay device.

Jet boil cooking unit.



Six month membership extension winner

The October winner of our free six month membership extension is Otago Club member, Graeme Oxley. Congratulations to Graeme, a member of 4 years standing, we value your continued support of our Club.

Members are reminded that this is an ongoing prize offer and the November renewals are coming up. To be in with a chance to win this prize, please get your renewals paid within the first two weeks of November.



A few reminders from your friendly editor...

Waipapa Crag Closure

NZAC have been in discussions with Mighty River Power (MRP) who are the landowners of the Waipapa Dam area. This has resulted in permanent closure of one area, and temporary closure of other areas. We urge climbers to note the restrictions on climbing outlined below, and adhere to them! If climbers want to continue to enjoy access to this fantastic climbing area then they must respect these requests. This ban includes all abseiling, and recreational, educational and commercial climbing instruction courses.

Car Park Wall Closure

The Car Park wall at Waipapa is closed to all climbers and the hardware is to be removed. This is at the request of the land owners, Mighty River Power, and the NZAC fully support this decision and ask that all climbers respect this closure and do not to climb in this area. Climbing in this area will only jeopardise future access to the other crags in the Waipapa area.

Lakeside and Crack Wall closures

Climbing at the Lakeside and Crack walls are closed. The NZAC are currently in negotiations with the land owners (MRP) and are working on solutions to reopen these areas. In the mean time please do not climb at either of these locations - MRP will install "No Climbing" signs at Lakeside track and wall. Climbing in these areas will only lead to a total ban and the removal of hardware from these crags.

River Wall, Main Cliff and Galaxy Wall

Climbing in these areas is still open. However please respect any track closure signs or requests during the construction of the national cycleway path. Climbers have a duty of care to respect any temporary request by land owners to limit access to an area. This can be done for any number of reasons such as construction in or around the area, lambing or calving, or logging.

Whanganui Bay

Carmen and Peter are now the people to see when camping or climbing at Whanganui Bay. If you need to contact Carmen you can call / text her on 027 656 4505. Carmen's bach is the green one with the flag and sign outside it.

Hangdog

After being shut down over winter for additions and alterations, Hangdog Camp at Payne's Ford is expecting to be open again by mid November / early December. For updates and to make a booking check out www.hangdogcamp.co.nz.



Film of an Alpine Club trip from 1949

A short film featuring a 1949 Alpine Club trip to Mt Aspiring hut and on to French Ridge can be viewed at www.nzonscreen.com/title/prelude-to-aspiring-1949



Freda Du Faur Centenary Celebrations

Tickets for the Freda Du Faur Centenary Celebrations are now for sale online and also available to purchase direct from the NZAC National Office. Two events are being held at Mt Cook Village on Saturday 4th December 2010 to commemorate Freda's great achievements - the first is an afternoon tea and forum with a great selection of guest speakers 2-5pm, tickets \$20pp. This will be followed by an evening buffet dinner with special guest speaker, Lydia Bradey, at 6:45pm tickets \$60pp.

Details on these two events and links to ticket sales can be accessed at <http://alpineclub.org.nz/event/freda-du-faur-centenary>



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Did I mention better routes?

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Very durable, light,
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- Graham Zimmerman



Half ropes

Unity 8mm x 50m STD-DRY TPT **\$205**

Unity 8mm x 50m 2X-DRY TPT **\$270**

Unity 8mm x 60m 2X-DRY TPT **\$320**

Unity 9mm x 60m 2X-DRY **\$330**

Single ropes

Equinox 10.2mm x 60m STD-DRY **\$230**

Glider 9.9mm x 60m 2X-DRY TPT **\$360**

Pinnacle 9.5mm x 60m 2X-DRY TPT **\$360**

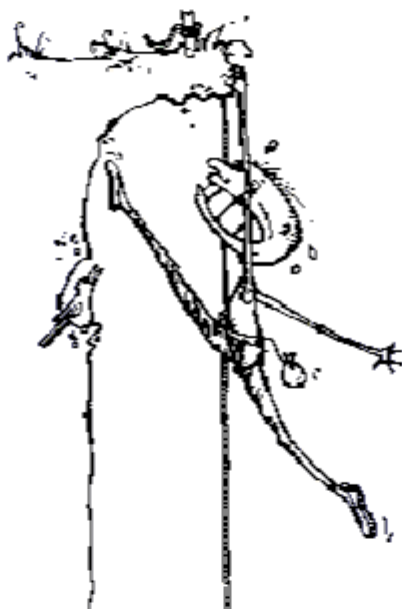
Dry treatments and TPT (reduced rope drag)
are detailed at www.iclimb.co.nz

*Maxim Ropes,
climbing brand of New England Ropes, USA*



WELLINGTON SECTION: 2010/11 CONTACT LIST

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	James Wright	chairperson	027 472 5561
Vice Chair	Scott Taylor	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h) 021 079 0854
Treasurer	Matt Knarston	treasurer	
National Rep	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
Instruction Convenor	Don French	DF	
Trips	Hinrich Schaefer	Trips	
Other Committee Members	Richard Davies	RD	
	Matt Knarston	MK	
	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Lorraine Johns	LJ	
	Hinrich Schaefer	HS	
	Rebecca Thomson	RT	
	Vincent Zintzen	VZ	
Other Roles:			
Gear	Marcus Manning	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Hinrich Schaefer	PLB	
Instruction - AIC	Don French	AIC or DF	06 3777 117 (h) 027 445 2980
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Derek Richardson	library	
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Richard Thomson	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz	03 3777 595



If undelivered please return to:

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